
2.3 Psychodynamic approach: Freud

Students will be assessed on their ability to:

- 1 Definition of the approach**
 - a Define the psychodynamic approach showing understanding that it is about the influence of unconscious processes on behaviour, and the importance of early childhood.
 - b Define and use psychological terminology accurately and appropriately including:
 - i id, ego, superego
 - ii stages (oral, anal, phallic, latency, genital)
 - iii repression
 - iv Oedipus complex
 - v defence mechanisms
 - vi conscious, preconscious, unconscious.

2 Methodology/ How Science Works

- a Describe and evaluate the case study as a research method used in psychology and as used in the psychodynamic approach.
- b Describe, assess and apply issues of reliability, validity, subjectivity, objectivity and generalisability in the analysis of qualitative data.
- c Evaluate Freud's theory in terms of credibility (eg Masson, 1989).
- d Describe, assess and apply the terms 'cross-sectional' and 'longitudinal' as applied to research methods.
- e Describe, assess and apply issues of ethics and issues of credibility with regard to using personal data from methods such as case studies (eg should such data be in the public domain?).
- f Describe and evaluate the correlational method/design.
- g Identify, describe and apply a positive and a negative correlation, and a strength (eg +0.87) of correlation.
- h Identify, describe and apply different sampling techniques including random sampling, stratified sampling, volunteer and self-selected sampling, and opportunity sampling, including advantages and disadvantages of each technique.

3 Content

- a Describe and evaluate Freud's theory of psychosexual development, including the five stages of development, the Oedipus complex, and the parts of personality associated with the first three stages, and including focusing on the explanation of gender development/behaviour.
- b Describe defence mechanisms including repression, and one other. Suitable examples: displacement, denial, projection and regression.
- c Evaluate Freud's theory as an explanation of gender development/behaviour, including comparison with explanations from the Biological and Learning Approaches.

4 Studies in detail

- a Describe and evaluate two studies in detail relating to Freud's theory. One study must be Freud's study of Little Hans (1909) and one other study. This **must** be selected from the following:
- Axline V (1964/1990) Dibs: Personality Development in Play Therapy
 - Bachrach et al (1991) Effectiveness of psychoanalytic therapies
 - Cramer P (1997) Identity, personality and defence mechanisms

5 Key issue

- a Describe **one** key issue of relevance to today's society and apply concepts, theories, and/or research (as appropriate) from the Psychodynamic Approach to explain the issue.

Suitable examples:

- effectiveness of psychoanalysis in treating abnormal and normal clients
- debate concerning the issue of false memory and repression
- debate concerning relationship of early childhood experience to later sexual orientation
- debate about whether dreams have meaning.

Note: in the examination paper, students may be given stimulus material from a key issue to explain using concepts, theories and/or research (as appropriate) from the Psychodynamic Approach.

6 Evidence of practice: short analysis task

- a Devise and conduct one practical, which must be use a correlational design, using two rating scales and self-report data. Class data collection is acceptable.

Suitable examples:

- collection of self-reports of own tidiness and own parent strictness
- self-reports using other sets of data such as obstinacy, orderliness and parsimony.

- b Draw a scattergram of the results.

- c Carry out a Spearman's test on the data and interpret the finding (eg $+0.87$ is a strong correlation).

Note: with regard to inferential tests, no calculations will have to be carried out in the examinations and formulae do not have to be learnt.

- d Write a short report of the procedure, sample, apparatus and results.

- e Assess the correlation as a research tool in terms of advantages and limitations.